Latino Museum Gets a Home on the National Mall

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For six years, the National Museum of the American Latino has not had a building of its own. Soon it will.

In August, the leaders of the **Smithsonian** voted to give the museum a **permanent** home in the Arts and Industries Building. This 145-year-old building is on the National Mall in Washington, D.C. Because the **Smithsonian** already owns it, the museum does not need **Congress** to approve a new site. President Trump has criticized the **Smithsonian**, and using a building it already owns avoids a possible **political** fight.

Jorge Zamanillo is the museum's **founding director**. He said people worked for more than 30 years to create the museum, with support from both **political** parties. A law creating it was passed in December 2020.

The building opened in 1881 as the **Smithsonian**'s first national museum. Now it will be home to its newest one. Zamanillo said the museum will share many different stories about Latinos in American history.

Word Treasure

permanent -- Meant to last for a very long time.

Smithsonian -- A group of national museums in Washington, D.C., run for the American people.

Congress -- The part of the U.S. government that makes the country's laws.

founding director -- The first leader of a new museum or group.

political -- Having to do with government and the people who run it.

Background you need

The National Mall is a long park in Washington, D.C., lined with famous museums and monuments.

Many of the museums there belong to the Smithsonian, and visiting them is free.

This new museum is meant to tell the stories and history of Latino people in the United States.

Break it down

WHO: The Smithsonian's leaders and museum director Jorge Zamanillo
WHAT: The National Museum of the American Latino will move into the Arts and Industries Building
WHERE: On the National Mall in Washington, D.C.
WHY: The museum has not had its own building, and the Smithsonian already owns this one

Why it matters

Kids who visit Washington, D.C., will be able to learn many stories about Latinos in American history in one place.

Test what you remember

1. What museum is getting a new home?

(A) The Toy Museum
(B) The Space Museum
(C) The Museum of Flight
(D) The National Museum of the American Latino

2. Which building will the museum use?

(A) The White House
(B) A new skyscraper
(C) The Arts and Industries Building
(D) A school

3. How old is the building?

(A) 10 years old
(B) 145 years old
(C) 50 years old
(D) 300 years old

4. Why does the museum not need Congress to approve a new site?

(A) The building is for sale
(B) The Smithsonian already owns the building
(C) The museum is very small
(D) Congress said no

5. Who is the museum's founding director?

(A) Jorge Zamanillo
(B) Donald Trump
(C) Robert Hall
(D) Jay Feely

6. When was a law creating the museum passed?

(A) December 2020
(B) July 1776
(C) January 2026
(D) August 1881

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: C 3: B 4: B 5: A 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Jorge Zamanillo (founding director): The museum will share many different stories about Latinos in American history.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):